

4 Cdn Div / JTFC Article Submission

Reference: [Maple Leaf Article – Submission Guidelines](#)

Title	<i>Title should have an active verb and 60 characters max. A title with an active verb can convey the gist of the article.</i>
A Career in the Army Reserve: My Progression from Co-op Student to Instructor	
Byline	<i>By Author Names, Unit</i>
By Master Corporal Andres Mona Jaramillo, Section Commander & Unit Public Affairs Representative with 4 th Battalion The Royal Canadian Regiment, London, ON	
Article	<i>The overall lead should not exceed approximately 450 words in English and 500 words in French. The language should be simple, and avoid jargon, passive voice, and long and juxtaposed sentences to the extent possible.</i>
Word count: 464 I joined the Army reserve when I was 18 years old, when in my final year of high school two recruiters would appear to offer the co-op program. I gave it a chance and have enjoyed amazing experiences in the past five years. What these recruiters spoke to my school about was an opportunity where we, as students, could train and become soldiers and receive high school credits. As a kid, I always wanted to be a soldier and many members of my family have served both in the Colombian and US militaries. During that time, I had opportunities that as an adolescent I would have never imagined I would accomplish. I completed my Basic training and the Infantry trade course, all within my 12th-grade year, and that summer I graduated as a fully qualified soldier. Throughout the years, I have had impactful experiences, such as participating in speaking engagements at elementary schools and high schools for Remembrance Day. I have also had the opportunity to work with the Canadian Rangers (3CRPG) and the junior rangers, supporting Indigenous communities and advancing the cause of reconciliation. During the height of the Covid pandemic, I supported my community throughout those troubling times in the capacity of a soldier, all while completing my university undergrad. At length, these experiences prepared me for the challenges of service. Being away, being cold, tired, in pain, and sometimes even a little stressed, being part of a team was the most rewarding. In more recent years, I have had the privilege and great responsibility of becoming a leader within the institution. Though many times an enormous challenge, I have had the advantage of being surrounded by experienced, professional, and dedicated mentors that have demonstrated the qualities of a good soldier and leader. Thanks to these opportunities, I have been a Section commander within my unit for nearly two years, I have had the amazing experience of teaching on an Infantry PLQ and ISCC, and even more recently, I was nominated as my Unit's Public Affairs Representative.	

All these experiences have been vital to my professional development. They have allowed me to improve and develop a plethora of skills in verbal and written communication, stress management, time management and so on. These skills have been tremendously advantageous and have helped me both while undertaking my bachelor's degree and now during the Master's I am currently studying.

In closing, the Army Reserve for me has become a profession, a passion, and most importantly, a family. I am privileged and excited to inform the new generation of the great opportunity they now have. That teenager, that was mentioned earlier, has now become a leader, and part of something bigger than he could have ever imagined and this same opportunity exists for so many others.

Captions

Captions must include the photo's file name, description of the photo and photo credit.

File Name 20221126LXC220154D023.jpg

Caption The 4th Canadian Division command team, Brigadier-General Josh Major and Chief Warrant Officer Jeramie Leamon discuss their response to a request for assistance from Ontario with Deputy Minister of Emergency Management, Bernie Derible.

Photo credit

Alt text

Metadata

Keywords

Exercise, Support, Toronto, Ontario, Disaster, Denison, Planning, Scenario, Training, Domestic, Liaising, Emergency



LOCAL COMMUNITY STORY FOR ST. **MAURICE WEEKLY**

**Article originally transcribed in French – Intended for Publication in L'Hedbo du St-Maurice, Newspaper -Shawinigan Quebec.*

30 November 2022



MCpl C. Fillion on the left and Capt J. Guimond on the right during their deployment on Operation Impact in Iraq.

STABILITY IN THE MIDDLE EAST - A MAURICIEN'S CONTRIBUTION

Shawinigan, Québec – Last year, Captain Julien Guimond of the 62nd Field Artillery Regiment, from the city of Shawinigan, was deployed on Operation IMPACT. OP IMPACT is a Canadian Forces operation to build the military capabilities of Iraq, Jordan, and Lebanon and acts as a means to strengthen ties with allies in the region. Ultimately, the Canadian Government seeks to continue working with partners in the Middle East to set conditions for stability and security. The captain also had the privilege of participating in Operation AEGIS, which was the contribution of the Canadian Armed Forces to the evacuation of Afghans with significant ties to the Government of Canada, and their accompanying family members.

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Captain Julien Guimond is a native of Mauricie and although he is only 30 years old, this counts as his second deployment. During these two operations, which lasted approximately 10 months, the member held a position in operations in Kuwait and the position of liaison officer in Iraq. Though he now speaks it, Captain Guimond initially struggled with English but was able to learn quickly in just a matter of months. The member is proud to have participated in the evacuation of approximately 3,700 Afghans to Canada and contributed to the continuing efforts to bring peace and stability to the Middle East.

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La guerre de la Marmite

C'ÉTAIT LE 6 OCTOBRE 1784. Moi, Capitaine Lieven van Isseghem, d'Ostende, j'avais été chargé d'une tâche vitale par son altesse impériale, l'empereur du Saint-Empire romain germanique. Nous devions remonter immédiatement l'Escaut et ignorer tous les navires hollandais, à moins d'une attaque de leur part. Notre bateau, *Le Louis*, avait quitté le port le matin même, accompagné par deux autres navires plus petits. Notre équipage n'était pas de taille considérable, mais était expérimenté. Les membres pour lesquels j'avais le plus de respect, c'étaient mon commandant en second, le lieutenant-capitaine Augustine de Launoy, un jeune homme à l'expérience militaire remarquable, le quartier-maître Vincent Wegmann, le membre le plus âgé et le plus têtu du groupe, qui avait participé à plus d'escarmouches que l'équipage au complet et le chapelain Germund Vahlen, un homme fortement instruit et de descendance aristocratique.

Quoiqu'étant un homme de Dieu, Vahlen était un pécheur tant par son attitude arrogante que par son fier caractère. Finalement, il y avait le cuisinier Gustav Schrempf, de faible stature, mais noble de caractère ; c'était un bon ami, même si on ne pouvait pas dire la même chose de sa cuisine. Avec ces bons messieurs et le reste de l'équipage, notre petit convoi se dirigeait vers Anvers.

Je sortis sur le pont, le matin même, pour examiner le bateau et l'équipage. Les membres travaillaient fort comme d'habitude. Les marins marchaient sur le pont, effectuant des tâches diverses. À la proue du navire se tenaient le lieutenant de Launoy et le chapelain Vahlen, avec un petit contingent de soldats. Le lieutenant me remarqua d'abord, inclina la tête dans ma direction. Je me dirigeai ensuite vers lui. À ma gauche, je distinguais l'un des bateaux qui nous accompagnaient. C'était un navire beaucoup plus petit, un navire marchand, à peine blindé et pratiquement sans aucune capacité offensive.

Le lieutenant et le chapelain avaient commencé à marcher vers moi. Le lieutenant fut le premier à parler.

— Bonjour, capitaine.

— Tout est en ordre, j'espère ?

— Oui, monsieur, bien sûr ! Le bateau et l'équipage, dit Launoy avec une certaine fierté.

— Vous prouvez vraiment votre valeur, monsieur de Launoy. J'espère que vous persisterez dans votre diligence.

Nous marchâmes le long du bateau, observant l'équipage et le paysage. C'était le début de l'après-midi, il faisait beau, il n'y avait ni pluie ni vent. Le paysage belge défilait devant nous ; c'était surtout plat, des terres agricoles, semblait-il. Au moment d'arriver à l'arrière du bateau, le lieutenant me regarda et me dit :

— Je tiens ma langue depuis quelque temps déjà, mais capitaine, je suis curieux de savoir exactement quelle est notre mission.

— On ne m'a pas donné beaucoup de détails. On m'a simplement ordonné d'escorter ces deux navires marchands sur l'Escaut.

Le lieutenant fit une pause, puis continua :

– Cette mission semble plutôt douteuse. Nous entrons dans des eaux hollandaises, ils nous verront comme une incursion agressive dans leurs eaux souveraines.

– Je ne m'inquièterais pas, lieutenant, lui dis-je, tentant de le rassurer. Les Néerlandais peuvent être têtus, mais ils ne sont pas complètement stupides. Je n'imaginerais pas qu'ils cherchent la guerre avec nous.

Le lieutenant avait maintenant le regard inquiet.

– Je ne fais pas confiance aux Néerlandais. Ils sont impitoyables autant qu'ils sont vicieux.

– Vous avez peut-être raison, monsieur de Launoy.

Je regardai au loin, vers l'horizon, puis ordonnai aux hommes de se rassembler, puisque nous étions sur le point d'arriver à Anvers.

Ce soir-là, mon cuisinier Gustav entra dans mes quartiers avec l'un de mes plats préférés. Il me souhaita bon appétit et me laissa à mes propres pensées. C'était l'un de ces moments rares où je pouvais me détendre. Je venais d'allumer ma pipe lorsqu'on frappa à ma porte.

– Capitaine, nous passons Anvers.

Sur le pont, l'équipage était tendu, le contingent de soldats divisé sur chacun des flancs du bateau. Là, à côté du mât, se tenaient le lieutenant, le chapelain et le quartier-maître Vincent Wegmann. Je marchai vers eux et saluai les trois hommes.

– Rapport, lieutenant !

– Nous approchons de ce qui semble être un fort à proximité d'Anvers.

Dans la distance, il était clair que le fort avait découvert les navires. Les Néerlandais avaient commencé à lancer des signaux réclamant au bateau de s'identifier.

Quand les trois bateaux passèrent le fort, le silence était assourdissant. Quelques instants plus tard, les trois bateaux

passaient Anvers. L'équipage avait l'air soulagé, le chapelain était remarquablement pâle, tandis que le lieutenant et le quart-maître paraissaient plutôt contents.

— Je me retire pour la nuit. Vous avez la commande du navire, lieutenant.

— Oui, capitaine, répondit fièrement le lieutenant.

Cette nuit-là, je fis un rêve épouvantable. J'étais debout sur ce qui semblait être le pont de mon propre bateau. Le brouillard était épais et on n'y voyait rien. Dans mon rêve, je ressentais une peur, mais de quoi, je ne pourrais le dire. Soudainement, j'entendis le son d'une explosion immense. Je sentis une grande chaleur comme si un objet me frôlait. Là où l'objet avait volé, le brouillard avait fondu et là, devant mes yeux, se trouvait une figure masquée, dans le noir. Comme je m'approchais de la figure, celle-ci commença à crier. Les cris étaient assourdissants, douloureux et misérables, comme les cris d'une mère qui avait perdu son enfant. La créature gémissait et criait plus fort à chaque moment. C'est alors que je perdis connaissance.

Je me réveillai en sursaut, suant profusément, et toujours avec ce sentiment horrible de crainte. Le rêve était un présage d'un événement à venir : d'un désastre, d'une mort ou d'une bataille.

Dans l'après-midi, je frappai à la porte du chapelain.

— Ah, monsieur van Isseghem, c'est une surprise ! me dit-il.

— Bonjour, monsieur Vahlen, je dois vous parler de quelque chose... de personnel.

C'était une petite pièce, avec un lit, un bureau et deux chaises adjacentes.

— S'il vous plaît, asseyez-vous. Dites-moi, quelle est cette affaire personnelle dont vous vouliez discuter ?

Je parlai au chapelain de mon rêve et lui dis tout ce que j'avais vu, tout ce que j'avais ressenti et tout ce que j'avais entendu. Quand je finis de parler, le chapelain devint silencieux pendant un certain temps. Lorsqu'il se mit enfin à parler, il était évidemment embarrassé.

— Je suis désolé... Je n'ai aucune idée de ce que votre rêve pourrait signifier. Ne vous inquiétez pas, capitaine, il ne faut pas prêter trop attention aux rêves ou aux présages.

Je quittai sa chambre, puis continuai ma journée, essayant de ne pas trop penser à mon rêve. Le convoi faisait des progrès significatifs. Plus tard, je me retirai comme à mon habitude et attendis Gustav ainsi que mon souper. Gustav était à l'heure comme d'habitude et je pus enfin apprécier mon repas et ma soirée sans interruption.

Cette nuit-là, je refis le même rêve. Là, devant moi se trouvait la figure désespérée, mais cette fois je pouvais voir quelque chose dans ses mains. L'objet que la créature tenait semblait être fait de métal, arrondi, mais je ne voyais pas de quoi il s'agissait. Je me réveillai ensuite et constatai que le lieutenant de Launoy se tenait debout devant moi.

— Capitaine, c'est urgent ! s'empessa-t-il de dire.

Je m'habillai rapidement. Le jour était très brumeux, mais je percevais la silhouette d'un très grand bateau, non loin d'où nous étions. Le lieutenant, le chapelain, le quartier-maître et le cuisinier Gustav m'accompagnaient. Le chapelain priait rigoureusement, le cuisinier tenait une marmite dans ses mains, l'air détendu, le quartier-maître semblait toujours aussi impassible et le lieutenant était comme à son habitude.

Le lieutenant indiqua la présence de l'autre bateau.

— Une frégate hollandaise, elle nous a interceptés et vient de tirer un coup de semonce.

— Nous attendons vos ordres, capitaine.

J'analysai la situation :

– Nous protégerons d'ici les deux autres bateaux, persévérez. Nous sommes plus petits, mais beaucoup plus rapides.

Le quartier-maître inclina simplement la tête et partit en courant. Le brouillard sembla alors s'épaissir et on entendit une énorme explosion.

Je me jetai sur le pont. Un projectile vola devant moi. Quelques moments passèrent, puis je me levai. C'est là que je les entendis, ces cris misérables. Près du mât du bateau se tenaient des membres de l'équipage, regardant quelque chose sur le pont. Je savais que ces cris atroces venaient de là. Je voyais le chapelain et le lieutenant, debout, leurs visages pleins de colère et de dégoût. J'écartai les autres pour voir ce qui était arrivé.

Là, au milieu, se trouvait le cuisinier Gustav, devant un objet métallique cabossé et autour de lui un liquide jaune verdâtre. Il pleurait et hurlait comme un fou.

– Maudits bâtards ! Qu'ils aillent au diable !

– Monsieur Gustav Schrempf, que faites-vous donc ?

Il m'ignora et continua.

– Ma marmite... ma soupe... oh ma soupe !

Je restai là, silencieux.

Le tir de canon du bateau hollandais avait frappé la marmite de Gustav, renversant toute la soupe qu'il avait préparée.

Andres Mona
École secondaire Gabriel-Dumont

Né aux États-Unis, Andres Mona a immigré au Canada avec sa famille à un jeune âge. Ses passions sont l'histoire, la politique et la philosophie. Fier d'être à la fois chrétien et canadien, Andres souhaite un jour devenir professeur d'histoire.

English Translation: Mona, Andres. "La guerre de la marmite." *Petites Chroniques éclatées : Nouvelles Littéraires*, Mordus des mots, Éditions David (2017): 25-30. Short story.

The Kettle War

It was the 6th of October 1784. I, Captain Lieven van Isseghem, of Ostend, had been charged with a vital task by His Imperial Highness, the Holy Roman Emperor. We were to immediately embark up the river Scheldt, ignoring all Dutch vessels, lest we be attacked. Our proud ship, *The Louis*, left the port that same day, accompanied by two other vessels. The ship's crew was not of considerable size but were well experienced. The members of which I respected the most were my second in command, the Lieutenant-Captain Augustine de Launoy, a young man with a remarkable skill for war, the Quartermaster Vincent Wegmann, the oldest, meanest, and most stubborn of the lot and the Chaplain Germund Vahlen, a well-educated man of noble descendance. And though a man of God, he was a great sinner due to his arrogance and the terrible proudness of his character. Finally, was the cook Gustav Schrempf, of weak stature and physique but of fierce character; he was a good friend, though not a very good cook. With these reliable men and the rest of the crew, our small party made its way to Antwerp.

That same day, I came out to the deck, to examine the boat and the crew. The men worked hard as per usual. The sailors walked along the deck and completed various tasks and errands. At the bow of the ship stood Lieutenant de Launoy and Father Vahlen, with a small contingent of soldiers. The lieutenant was the first to notice me and subsequently bowed his head in my direction. I headed towards him and the group. To my left, I could distinguish one of the ships that was accompanying us. It was a much smaller vessel, a merchant ship, barely armored and with practically no offensive capabilities. The lieutenant and the chaplain had also already begun to walk towards me. The lieutenant was the first to speak.

-Good day, Captain.

-Everything is in order, I hope.

-Sir, yes of course! Both the boat and the crew are ready! said de Launoy with a certain youthful pride.

-You very much prove your value, Mr. de Launoy. I hope you will persist in your professional diligence.

We walked along the length of the ship, observing the crew and the landscape as we sailed by. It was the beginning of the afternoon, it was pretty, there was little wind and no rain. The Flemish countryside passed before us; mostly flat, agricultural lands they appeared to be. When we arrived at the rear of the ship, the lieutenant looked at me directly and said:

-Sir, I have held my tongue for some time now, but my Captain, I must know what exactly we have been tasked with.

-I was not given many details. I was merely ordered to immediately escort these two merchant ships on the Scheldt.

The lieutenant paused for a moment before carrying on:

-This mission seems rather dubious. We are entering Dutch waters, they will certainly view our actions as an aggressive incursion.

-I would not be worried, Lieutenant, I told him, attempting to reassure him. The Dutch can be and have been quite stubborn, but they are not utterly stupid. I would not think they would risk war with us.

The Lieutenant now looked worried.

-I would put little confidence in the Dutch for anything. They are as cruel as they are unforgiving.

-You may be correct Mr. de Launoy.

I looked into the distance, towards the horizon and then ordered the men to assemble, as we were nearly arriving at Antwerp.

Later that night, the cook Gustav entered my quarters with one of my favorite dishes. He wished me a pleasant meal and left me to my own thoughts and devices. It was one of the few even rare moments where I could ease up. I had just lit my pipe when came knocking from the door.

-Captain, we are arriving at Antwerp.

On the deck, the entire crew stood ready, soldiers flanked either side of the ships. Beside the main mast was located the Lieutenant, the Chaplain, and the Quartermaster Wegmann. I paced towards them and greeted all three men.

-Report, Lieutenant!

-We are approaching what appears to be a defended position in close proximity to Antwerp.

In the distance, it was clear that the fort had spotted the small flotilla. The Dutch had begun to send off signals in order to identify our vessels. But as the three ships passed the fort, the silence was deafening. And only a few moments later, the flotilla carried on to Antwerp without harassment or issue from the fort. Strange, I thought. However, the crew seemed relieved, the Chaplain was remarkably pale, but both the Lieutenant and the Quartermaster appeared more or less content with the outcome of the situation.

-I will retire now for the night. You have command of the ship.

-Yes Sir. Answered the young Lieutenant.

In my room that night, I suffered a most horrible dream. I was standing on what seemed to be the deck of my ship. The fog was thick and nothing could be seen. In my dream, I felt the greatest dread, but to what or who I could not say. Suddenly, I heard the crack of an explosion, and I felt such an intense heat, as if I were burning. The explosion had swept aside the fog, and where it had occurred stood a blackened and masked figure. I was compelled to walk forwards, towards the shadow figure. As I did, it began to scream. Its screams were deafening, painful and miserable, like the cries of a mother who has lost their child. The creature wretched and cried louder with the passing of each moment. It was then that I woke up. I woke up with a startle, sweating profusely and still with that horrible feeling of dread. The dream had to be an omen of an event or thing to come maybe a disaster, or a death or a battle.

The morning passed and that afternoon, I knocked on the door of the priest.

-Ah, Mr. Van Isseghem, what a surprise! He exclaimed.

-Good day Mr. Vahlen, I must speak with you... about a personal matter.

It was a small room, with a bed, a desk and a single chair.

-Please, sit. Tell me, what is this personal matter you'd wish to discuss?

I told the Chaplain about my dream and about everything I saw, everything I felt and I everything I heard. When I finished speaking, the priest was silent for some time. When he finally began to speak, it was evident that he was perplexed.

-Truly, I am sorry... I have no idea what your dream could signify. I would not worry Captain, do not put much faith in dreams or in supposed omens.

I left his chambers, after these words and continued my command of the voyage, trying not to think upon my dream. The convoy had made significant progress up the Scheldt. Later that day, I retired to my quarters as was my custom and awaited Gustav for my supper. Gustav was on time,

as was custom, and I enjoyed my meal and the remainder of the evening without interruption. During the night, I relived the same dream. Before me, stood the shadowy figure, however, this time I could discern an object in its hands. The object in the creatures' hands appeared to be made from metal and it was rounded but I could not make out fully what it was. I woke up suddenly and was quick to notice Lieutenant de Launoy standing before me.

-Captain! It is urgent.

I dressed myself quickly and made my way to the deck. The day was exceedingly foggy, but I could perceive the silhouette of a very large ship, not far ahead of where we were. The lieutenant, the chaplain, the quartermaster and the cook all stood with me. The priest prayed vigorously, the cook held a large kettle he had brought from the kitchen, the quartermaster appeared unbothered and the lieutenant maintained his bearings. The lieutenant then indicated the presence of the other ship.

-A Dutch frigate. She intercepted us and has just fired a warning shot. We await your orders, Captain.

I analyzed the situation:

-We will protect the other two boats at all costs, stand fast. We may be smaller, but we are far faster.

The crew agreed and ran off to fulfill their Captain's orders. For a moment, the fog and the mist appeared to thicken before a massive explosion ripped across the water. I threw myself down on the deck, a projectile had flown past me. Some moments passed and I stood up. It was then that I heard those miserable cries. Near the ship's mast was gathered the majority of the crew, all looking at something on the deck. I knew that the screams originated from that spot. I could see the priest and the lieutenant, standing, their faces flush with anger and disgust. I push passed

crowd to see what was happening. There, in the middle of the mass of people, was the cook Gustav. Before the cook was a metal object turned over and a yellow liquid that surrounded him.

The cook was crying and screaming like a madman.

-Those bastards! Let them go to hell!

-Mr. Gustav Schrempf, what on Earth are you doing!?!?

He ignored me and continued.

-My kettle... my soup... oh my soup.

I stood there silently. With no words to spare. The warning shot from the Dutch ship had struck Gustav's kettle, spilling all the soup he had prepared and marking the sole casualty of the day.